

AMD expands graphics support for Ubuntu and Red Hat Enterprise Linux

AMD has released the AMDGPU-PRO 16.40 graphics driver with support for Ubuntu and Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL). The updated driver has emerged over two months after the release of the previous graphics driver, and is built for various AMD Radeon R-series GPUs.

The latest AMDGPU-PRO version supports 64-bit Ubuntu 16.04 LTS as well as RHEL 7.2. It also includes support for APIs such as OpenGL 4.5 and GLX 1.4, OpenCL 1.2, Vulkan 1.0, VDPAAU and Vulkan support for DOTA2. Additionally, there is an option to install script and Debian packages for Ubuntu 16.04.



In addition to its support to an expanding range of Linux operating systems, the AMDGPU-PRO 16.40 driver includes support for AMD Radeon R9 M485X, R7 M465, R7 M460, R7 M445 and R7 M440. The updated driver also comes with FirePro features such as EDID management and 30-bit colour support.

AMD has acknowledged some limitations alongside the upgraded support on the new graphics driver. It lags while producing graphics for the 'Company of Heroes 2' game and, on certain platforms, users are unable to log in to the system after its installation.

You can download the updated AMD graphics by visiting its global support website. The site also offers the same driver package for RHEL 6.8.

Maru OS now comes with Android Marshmallow

Maru OS, which got open sourced earlier this year, has now been updated to version 0.3. The new update brings Android 6.0.1 Marshmallow to all virtual environments, including desktops and mobile devices.

Originally running on Android 5.1 Lollipop, Maru OS now provides the Marshmallow flavour. The arrival of the new Android platform on Maru OS comes along with features such as improved power management, enhanced app permissions and up-to-date security patches.

Apart from Android

Marshmallow, Maru OS v0.3 allows users to start the Maru Desktop experience on a large screen even without an HDMI screen. Users just need to enable Maru Desktop from the dashboard to run the service in the background. This helps if the Maru OS-enabled phone is yet to be plugged into an HDMI display. Also, you can use SSH services if you have switched to the desktop mode.

For high-resolution displays with over a 1080p pixel-count, Maru OS now comes with an 'Enhanced resolution matching' mode. This grabs the native resolution of the connected display and overrides the device's stock matching algorithm. The updated version additionally includes several performance improvements and bug fixes.

You can upgrade your existing Maru OS device to version 0.3 by following an upgrading guide on GitHub. It is worth noting here that if you are about to install the operating system for the first time and want to experience virtual environments on Android, you need to have a Nexus 5.



Ubuntu Core 16 brings security closer to IoT devices

Security has been one of the significant concerns in the open source world over the past several months. But now, Canonical has released Ubuntu Core 16 to ensure a reliable and secure experience on Internet of Things (IoT) devices.

The latest Ubuntu Core is a compact platform. Yet, it is capable of delivering what the company claims is groundbreaking security through confined, read-only Snap packages. The operating system also comes with Update Control to enable software publishers and manufacturers to validate updates way before they are applied to the devices. This helps in reducing instances of vulnerabilities.

To offer transactional upgradability for the entire platform, the operating system and kernel in Ubuntu Core are also delivered as Snaps. Manufacturers can use the device-centric Snap app store on Ubuntu's site to let developers release updates throughout the device's lifecycle, starting from beta testing to general availability.

IoT device makers like Dell believe that the release of Ubuntu Core 16 will enable them to offer long-term support and security on their offerings. This would help them influence more customers to test their innovations.

